



Strategic Orientation 1

Understand the Language & Process as you develop your Strategic Plan.

Our Session Objective

Welcome, it's all about you and your business today...

- Everyone contributes to collaborative thinking.
- Planned Breaks & Housekeeping
- **My/Our Role in the Planning Session is to Challenge What You Believe To Be True!**
- **Your Role is to be Ready To Explore Issues/ Ideas With an Open Heart and an Open Mind.**
- The Objective (expectations) for Today's meeting is that we 'Discover What We've Been Missing'!
- Record what we learn.
- Build an action plan going forward.

Agenda:

- Review the Planning Process & Language to ensure we're all on the 'same page'. **(section 1)**
- Assess current position by reviewing (pre-meeting) data **(section 2)** & Financial Performance Reports
- Determine the business Strategic Objective & document the Strategy **(section 3)**
- Brainstorm & record Operational Objectives and Tactics (actions) in the Automated Action Plan Reminder

Section 1:

Formal Planning Process & Language

Our Planning Process

1. Assess Current Position

- Client Base & Skill Base
- Review Team, Customer & Supplier Insights
- Resource
- Financial Position
- (Use Strength / Weakness prompts - Internal)
- Use Revenue & Volatility models to aid self assessment

2. Develop Strategic Scenarios

- (Use P.E.S.T prompts - External)
- Develop Scenario Matrix using two greatest impact drivers.
- Select Scenarios you wish to prepare for.
- This task is both time consuming and technical therefore you may choose to complete in a separate session

3. Determine Strategic Objective

- 'The end game' with consideration of on-going management.
- Develop 'profile points' to provide clarity yet maintain flexibility.
- This section may be influenced/reversed by stage 4.

4. Determine Strategy

- Reach agreement on Ethos or 'Philosophy' behind business decisions.

5. Determine Operational Objectives

- Look for common elements in Scenario Analysis to prioritise Operational Objectives
- These objectives should be kept brief in number and reflect the Strategic Objective whilst being consistent with agreed Strategy.
- Objectives should be tested against the '9 Growth Aspects' to ensure strong organisational health.

6. Tactics

- Task. Whom. When
- Once delegated to those responsible, they have input into methodology and are ultimately responsible for task delivery within allocated timelines.



Strategy

The EFFECTIVE MEANS OF EMPLOYING AND DEPLOYING MEN AND RESOURCES TO ACHIEVE A POLITICAL OUTCOME.

(Derived from the Greek word “Strategia” meaning office of general or commander, art of troop leader, command, leadership. “Strategos” General of Army, “Strategoi” Collective Generals advising political leaders)

Objective:

A CLEARLY DEFINED, DESIRED RESULT IN A GIVEN CAMPAIGN OR ENGAGEMENT.

Tactics:

THE ACTUAL MEANS USED TO SECURE AN OBJECTIVE

Examples of Military Strategies	As They Relate to Business...
Attrition warfare (Inflicting greater losses & Eliminating supplies over time. Also known as 'Static Warfare')	Price War
Scorched Earth (Withdrawal over vast distances whilst removing useable resource for the approaching armies)	Saturating the market to ensure its not cost effective for new players to enter the market.
Blitzkrieg (Rapid movement of men and machine to secure strategic vantage points. Effectively avoiding the attrition of 'static warfare')	Innovation, Design, Rapid Product Enhancement.
Blockade (Eliminating the armies supplies without direct confrontation or declaration of war.)	Contractual exclusivity or limitation
Guerrilla ('Hit and run tactics') Reduces the effective advantage of size and power.	Niche marketing
Deception / Feint (False withdrawal or unit placement to draw enemy into chosen battlegrounds)	Pre-release marketing of prototype models.
Siege. Sieges involve surrounding the target (city/town) to block provision of supplies or reinforcements and the escape of troops. A tactic known as 'investment'.	'Ring fencing' client relations by providing multiple service lines & involving the client's existing business network.

'4-Box' Strategic Language

Desired end result (Singular) inclusive of on-going management plans.

Strategic Objective

The Ethos or beliefs about how best to achieve the **Strategic Objective**, (effectively an 'acid test')

Strategy

Significant Intermediary steps to achieve the **Strategic Objective** requiring planning & prior knowledge of the Strategic Objective.

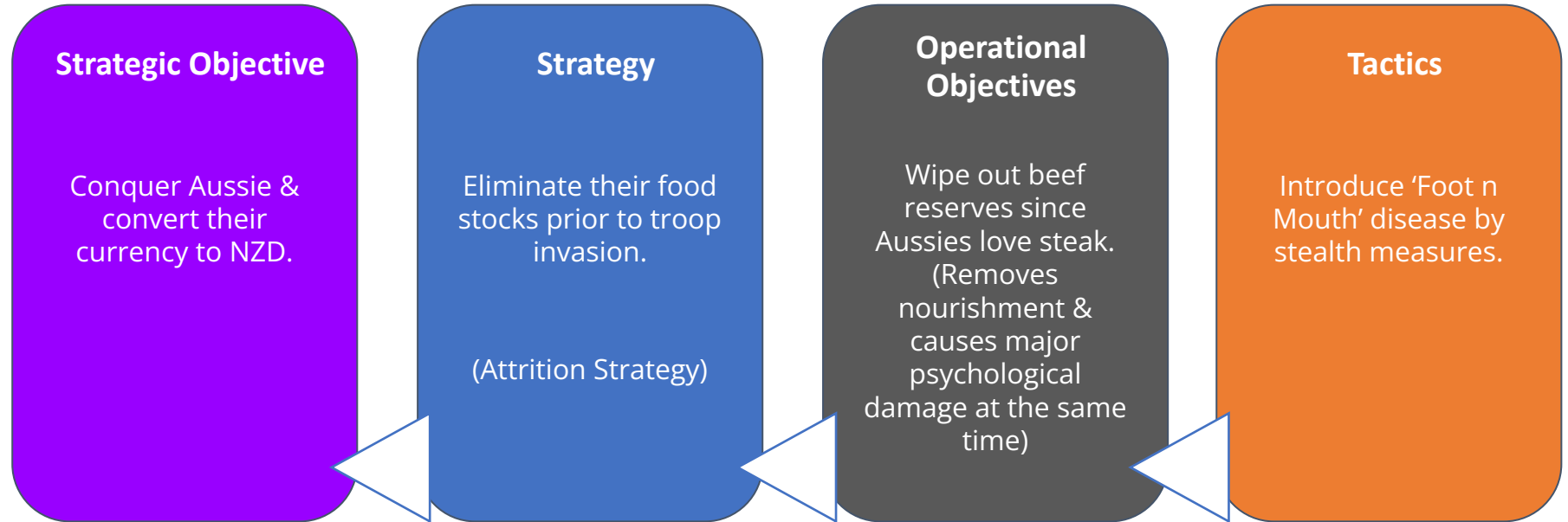
Operational Objectives

Methods used to achieve the **Operational Objectives**, often requiring 'on the ground' problem solving skills.

Tactics



Terminology Example



Operational Objective:

Operational objectives are many and varied depending on the initial framework being used but by definition, ALL must pass the following test to ensure they are correctly defined.

1. Is the objective Observable / Measurable in it's DEFINITIVE ASSESSMENT? (either achieved or failed)
2. Is the objective bound by a specific timeframe?
3. Is the objective clearly in support of achieving the (singular) STRATEGIC Objective? (As a '**Milestone**' – does it serve as a resourcing or execution component of the plan?)

The Things We Want To Achieve...

	Operational Objective	Whom	When
Poor Example	Increase Sales		
Correct Example	Achieve \$150,000 per month in ongoing regular sales (as averaged over 3 mth period)	Billy	End of Sept 2016

* USE THE ACTION PLAN REMINDER TO RECORD YOUR OPERATIONAL OBJECTIVES & ACTIONS *

Collaborative Thinking

In many cases, a number of 'well-meaning' individuals may be contributing to the business discussion. However, due to the often misuse of planning terminology, people can become confused and begin thinking in terms of cross purposes.

Edward De Bono highlights the power of 'collaborative thinking' in his '6-hats thinking' technique as being the crucial element in modern business problem solving.

Collaborative thinking can best be described as "no side – but everyone from all sides"

Action Story. Christchurch Building Engineers. (Draw the building with 4 people, 1 each side)

De-Bono explained how the '3 G's' (Greek philosophers, Socrates, Aristotle & Plato) sought truth via questions and combined many 'lines of thought' for extending their understanding. The Catholic Church introduced 'Argumentative Theory' and sought truth via a logical argument of two sides (positive and negative) which made it easier to label people as Heretics and 'remove them'. This style of thinking was not developed for 'creative value'.

Field Intelligence

Colin James of Altmore International summarised Howard Gardner's 'Emotional Intelligence' (below) but it's the notion of 'Field Intelligence' that interests us most in regards to effective strategic planning. This dovetails beautifully with E. De-Bono's theory of collaborative thinking and explains the value of 'another set of eyes' provided, the framework aligns the 'view or perspective' as we discussed in the 4 side diagram.

The 4 key domains of intelligence are as follows;

1. Cerebral/ Logical/ Analytical
2. Mature Emotional (Ability to hold conflicting information in harmony)
3. Somatic or Intuitive
4. 'Field Intelligence'. (That of contextual awareness outside and within the body. This is where 'group intelligence' resides)

In order to achieve real 'collaborative thinking' the minds of the team must be directed via structure (templates) and language. This achieves the power of 'the sum is greater than its parts' and it's in the space of collaboration that real innovation occurs...

Simply getting everybody focused on the same topic with the same terminology will increase the effectiveness of your business planning sessions 10 fold.

Section 2:

Pre-Planning Meeting Data Collection & Review

Team Insights

Review the Internal Team Insights page of the Insights Summary template.

(this information will need to have been gathered PRIOR to this meeting - of course.)

Customer & Skills Insights

Review the Customer & Skills review template.

(this information will need to have been gathered PRIOR to this meeting - of course.)

Section 3:

Planning Meeting Thoughts & Actions

Financial Performance - Assets Review

Take the time to review your recent financial performance; including a review of business assets.

(Stored in pdf storage or performance reports section)

Strengths & Weakness Review

Complete the S.W.O.T analysis table to record your defined Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats.

(You don't have to complete them in any set order, just record them as they come to mind...)

Strategic Statements

Complete the Strategic Statements table to record your defined Strategic Objective and (Overarching) Business Strategy.

(You can choose to complete this here or as part of Strategic Orientation part 2 - exact same table)

Operational Objectives

Brainstorm & record your Operational Objectives and Tactics
(actions) in the Automated Action Plan Reminder

Notes:

Enter your thoughts here...